A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO STRATA

Mac Guide

Installation and First Experiments

Step by step from scratch, no programming needed



cd ~/sirisys · 24 · 58 · 6 · 12 · 16 · same ledger: YES

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Independent interpretation · no affiliation with SIRISYS

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A step-by-step guide from scratch for STRATA, an independent software interpretation of SIRISYS (version 13.5). No programming needed, and no prior use of the Terminal.

Before you start

You will need:

- Your Mac and an internet connection.
- The STRATA repository on GitHub: github.com/juanan-prz/STRATA (step 1 explains how to download it).
- For the experiments with a model: Ollama, free and local (recommended), or an Anthropic API key (optional). The functional tests need neither.

The first time takes about 30 minutes of installation. After that, each session starts in a minute.

GOLDEN RULE

Copy and paste the commands exactly as they are, without changing anything. One extra space or a misplaced character and they fail. Copying and pasting is the right way, not cheating.

A guide to an independent interpretation in software. STRATA is not an official SIRISYS work and implies no affiliation with SIRISYS.

Step 1 Download the project

- Open https://github.com/juanan-prz/STRATA in Safari.
- Click the green **Code** button and then **Download ZIP**.
- Open the downloaded ZIP (double-click): a folder appears.
- Move it to your **home folder** (the one with your user name and a house icon) and rename it to exactly sirisys (lower case, no accents or spaces).

CAUTION

Do not put it in Documents or on the Desktop. If iCloud syncs them with «Optimise Mac Storage», it may keep the files only in the cloud; with Wi-Fi off, the programs cannot read them and the test comes out empty without warning.

Inside, together and with no subfolders, you should find these files (among others):

File	What it is for
Sirisys_Framework_v13_5.py	The system.
Sirisys_Server.py · sirisys_loader.py	Start experiment mode, with the live view.
Sirisys_Live_Visualizer.html	The live view of the field.
Sirisys_Static_Visualizer.html	The inspector: examines a saved instance afterwards.
run_report.py	Measured runs: writes a report with their results.
field_topology.py · sirisys_measures.py	Measurements the reports use. They also check that the model answers.
test_*.py · sirisys_testkit.py	Functional tests: five files and what they share.
measure_phase3.py · live_c2.py · soak.py	Measurements: criteria, real percepts and a long life.
requirements.txt	The list of pieces to install.

Always download on the computer, not on a phone. If the files pass through a phone's clipboard or a rich-text editor, the quotation marks get corrupted and the code stops working.

When a new version comes out, rename the old folder (for example, sirisys_v134) before downloading the new one: that way you keep its results and the files do not mix.

Step 2 Open the Terminal

The Terminal is a window where you type commands instead of clicking. Press Command + Space, type Terminal and press Enter. A window opens with a blinking cursor. You cannot break anything by typing there: if a command does not exist, it simply says so.

Step 3 Check whether you have Python

Copy this into the Terminal and press Enter:

```
python3 --version
```

If it answers Python 3.10 or higher (for example 3.12.4), you have it: skip to step 4. If it says command not found, offers to install developer tools, or the version is older: go to python.org/downloads, click the yellow Download Python button, install it like any other application, close the Terminal, open it again and repeat the command.

Step 4 Go to the folder

```
cd ~/sirisys
ls
```

The first goes into the folder; the second lists what is inside. It should list the files from step 1. If you see them, you are on track.

Step 5 Install the pieces

```
pip3 install -r requirements.txt
```

You will see a lot of text scroll by: that is normal and takes a couple of minutes. When you can type again, it has finished. If a red warning says externally-managed-environment (it usually happens with Homebrew's Python), use this line instead:

```
pip3 install --break-system-packages -r requirements.txt
```

Step 6 Check that everything works (free, no model)

Run these five tests, one at a time. They cost nothing and need no internet:

Command	What it should say at the end
python3 test_sirisys.py	SUMMARY: 24/24 passed (≈ 15 s)
python3 test_phase1.py	SUMMARY: 58/58 passed (≈ 20 s)
python3 test_phase2_guarantee.py	SUMMARY: 6/6 passed (≈ 5 s)
python3 test_phase4.py	SUMMARY: 12/12 passed (≈ 5 s)
python3 test_ontology.py	SUMMARY: 16/16 passed (≈ 5 s)

If any line says FAIL, note which test failed and the lines before it; download the ZIP again on the computer and repeat, since a damaged file is the most common cause. To see the field live:

```
python3 Sirisys_Server.py --play
```

Open http://127.0.0.1:8000 in Safari. To stop it, go back to the Terminal and press Control + C: the instance is saved in the sirisys_runs folder and nothing is deleted. To examine it afterwards, open Sirisys_Static_Visualizer.html in Safari and choose the state.json in its folder.

Step 7 Choose the model

The model is optional and only translates: it gives readable names to what the field produces and words a question at each approach to the Sombunal. What it says never changes what the field does: a life with a model leaves the same record as one without.

Option A — Ollama (recommended). The model runs inside your Mac: free, and nothing is sent out.

- Download it from ollama.com and install it like any other application. It keeps running in the background, with an icon in the menu bar.
- In the Terminal, download a model. For example:

```
ollama pull llama3.1
ollama list
```

ollama list should show the downloaded model; if it answers with an error, Ollama is not running: open it. Always use the same model in the runs you intend to compare.

Option B — Anthropic (optional, for experiments only). At console.anthropic.com create an account, go to API Keys → Create Key, copy the key (it starts with sk-ant-; it is shown only once) and add credit under Billing without turning on automatic reload. A Claude subscription does not include API credit: they are separate. Then, in the Terminal:

```
export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY="sk-ant-your-key-here"
```

It answers nothing: that means it worked. It lasts while the window stays open. Never store the key in a file in the folder.

Step 8 The short report test

```
python3 run_report.py --cycles 20 --seeds 1 --backend ollama --profile minimal
```

(With Anthropic, change ollama to anthropic.) Before it starts, the program makes three real calls to the model. Look at:

What to look for	What it should say
The 16 check lines at the start	All with [ok].
model probe	ok, and the seconds per name and per question with a run's thread. If the model does not answer or answers empty, the program stops here with STOP and says why (see «If something fails»).
sample names	Two bare names, not sentences. «SYSTEM_AM» is a name; «The emergent construct is SYSTEM_AM.» is a sentence.
At the end: model calls	failures 0 and empty 0.
At the end: same ledger in every arm	YES: the field leaves the same record with the model and without it.

Step 9 Suggested experiments

A short sequence, with the minimal profile (no narration, no time of day), in this order. The long ones start with caffeinate -i: it keeps the Mac awake while the test runs and stops on its own when it ends. Do not close the Terminal window; on a laptop, keep it plugged in with the lid open.

1 · The control, no model (a few seconds). The field with three synthetic percept streams: it checks that the field meets its criteria on your machine. At the end, the criteria line should say PASS on all three; if one says FAIL, run it again with the Mac idle, since one of the measures is how long each cycle takes.

```
python3 run_report.py --backend none --profile minimal --cycles 1000 --seeds 3
mv sirisys_report.json control_report.json
```

The second command renames the report so that the next one does not overwrite it.

2 · Real percepts, no model (≈ 10 minutes). The field with your Mac's percepts over a long life: it checks that the field holds on what it really perceives. The result stays in the file (step 10). The field perceives the processor and the memory: close every application first (Ollama too) and do not use the Mac while it runs.

```
caffeinate -i python3 live_c2.py 10000 none minimal > live_none.json
```

3 · Real percepts with the model, and its replay without it (half an hour to two hours). It checks that what the model says does not change what the field does. With Ollama running and nothing else open. At the start it says in the Terminal the most time it will take.

```
caffeinate -i python3 live_c2.py 100 ollama minimal > live_ollama.json
python3 live_c2.py 100 none minimal --replay live_ollama.json > live_replay.json
```

The second lives the same life again, with the same percepts, without a model, and takes a few seconds. At the end it should say same ledger as the replayed run: YES.

While live_c2.py runs nothing else appears on screen: that is normal, it writes the result at the end. If the model stops answering halfway (Ollama closes or hangs), the program stops on its own and says so in the Terminal with STOPPED. Start Ollama and run that same command again; the interrupted file is not needed.

Optional: watch the field live with the model.

```
export SIRISYS_LLM_BACKEND=ollama
python3 Sirisys_Server.py --play --profile minimal
```

Open http://127.0.0.1:8000 as in step 6. Hovering over a construct shows the name the model gave it and, below, its key, the field's own. The model is shown at the top; if it stops answering, the field pauses, the header marks it in red (watch tripped) and the event log says why. Never at the same time as a test: stop it with Control + C before starting the next one.

Step 10 Your results

The sirisys folder will now hold four files:

- control_report.json, the control;
- live_none.json, the real percepts without a model;
- live_ollama.json, the real percepts with the model;
- live_replay.json, its replay without a model.

They are text files (JSON): each records the run's configuration, the self-adjustment criteria and their verdict, the model's health, the timings and the ledger head. Those with a model also keep every name it gave, with its whole answer. The technical guide (SIRISYS_Guide_v13_EN.md) explains what each one contains. To compare results across machines or models, also note:

- the name of the Ollama model you used (ollama list shows it);
- your Mac's chip and memory (Apple menu → About This Mac).

If something fails

What you see	What to do
command not found: python3	Python is not installed: go back to step 3.
No such file or directory	You are not in the folder or files are missing: repeat step 4 and check with ls.
externally-managed-environment	Use the second line of step 5.
A test says FAIL	Download the ZIP again on the computer and repeat. If it still fails, note the test and its message.
model active: False · STOP: ... not available	Ollama is not running (ollama list gives an error: open it and repeat), the model is not downloaded or, with Anthropic, the key was not set in this window.
STOP: ... answered empty	The model «thinks» before answering and runs out of room for the name. Use a general-purpose model, for example llama3.1 (step 7).
STOPPED — model health	The model stopped answering halfway. Start Ollama and run that command again.
same ledger ...: NO	It is a bug in the code, not a result: keep the output and report it on GitHub.
The .json file is 0 bytes	The folder is in Documents or on the Desktop, synced with iCloud: move it to your home folder (step 1) and repeat.
authentication_error / 401 · credit balance is too low	With Anthropic: the key was copied wrong (copy all of it, without spaces) or there is no credit at console.anthropic.com → Billing.
already open by another writer	Another SIRISYS is writing in that folder: close the other Terminal window or press Control + C in it.
Address already in use	Experiment mode is already running in another Terminal window: stop it there with Control + C.
The test stopped when the Mac slept	Run it again with caffeinate -i in front; on a laptop, plugged in with the lid open.
The window seems stuck	Normal: it is working. If it really hung, Control + C.

Summary

Each session starts in the folder, and it is worth checking that everything works:

```
cd ~/sirisys
python3 test_sirisys.py
python3 test_phase1.py
python3 test_phase2_guarantee.py
python3 test_phase4.py
python3 test_ontology.py
```

The sequence of experiments from step 9:

```
python3 run_report.py --backend none --profile minimal --cycles 1000 --seeds 3
mv sirisys_report.json control_report.json
caffeinate -i python3 live_c2.py 10000 none minimal > live_none.json
caffeinate -i python3 live_c2.py 100 ollama minimal > live_ollama.json
python3 live_c2.py 100 none minimal --replay live_ollama.json > live_replay.json
```

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